Speakout 3RD EDITION

THE TIME MACHINE by HG Wells (B1–B2)

INTRODUCTION

Ss listen and read an extract from The Time Machine by HG Wells, in which a Time Traveller arrives 800,000 years in the future. Then they listen to a later extract in which he travels 30 million years into the future to a dying Earth. Ss talk about time travel and find out about the natural end of the Earth.

Supplementary Materials

ACTIVE INVESTIGATION Ex 4: internet access

CLIL CONNECTION: internet access OR the science section in a library

WARM UP

Choose a year and describe some important historical events and ask Ss to guess the year (e.g. 1969 astronauts landed on the moon; 1914 First World War started; 2001 September 11th World Trade Centre attack; 1946 Italy voted to become a Republic).

Culture notes

HG Wells

Herbert George Wells (1866–1946) was born in Bromley, Kent, in the United Kingdom. Wells studied biology and, leaving science college without a degree, taught for four years. He settled in London and from 1893 became a full-time writer. *The Time Machine* (1895) was his first novel, and this was followed by other science fiction classics, such as *The Island of Dr Moreau* (1896), *The Invisible Man* (1897), *The War of the Worlds* (1898) and *The First Men in the Moon* (1901). He wrote other books but it is for his science fiction stories that he is chiefly remembered today.

The Time Machine

A group of men, including the narrator, are listening to the Time Traveller discuss his theories on time. The Time Traveller produces a miniature time machine and makes it disappear into thin air. He then shows his disbelieving guests a full-scale time machine, which he has made in his laboratory. The Time Traveller proceeds to tell the story of how he travelled to the year 802,701, and found the world occupied by the Eloi and their enemies, the Morlocks. He becomes friends with one of the Eloi, Weena, when he saves her from drowning. After she dies in a fire, the Time Traveller is forced to escape from the Morlocks on his own. He does, and then takes his time machine even farther into the future to see the end of the world. He leaves again the next day, and though he says he will return, the Time Traveller is never seen again.

PREPARATION

THINKING ROUTINE

1

see, think

Focus Ss on the picture of the futuristic city. Elicit onto the board things they can see in the picture (e.g. skyscrapers, glass buildings, trees, domes, greenhouses, fl ying saucers). Tell them it's in the future and ask *How many years in the future do you think this is*? Tell them it's 800,000 years in the future.

Divide Ss into pairs to quickly discuss *think* Question 3 and to give a reason for their answer. Do a class vote to see how many people would like to time travel there and how many wouldn't. For feedback, elicit a few ideas for why and why not.

wonder

Focus Ss on the words in the box and check Ss understand them all. Allow time for them to discuss the question in pairs. Monitor and help with vocabulary as needed and note anything useful on the board. Discuss ideas as a class.

COMPREHENSION

READING PREVIEW

Tell Ss they're going to read an extract from *The Time Machine* about a Time Traveller who travels 800,000 years in the future. Make sure they know that the picture in 'see' above is not a representation of the futuristic world in the book.

READING EXTRACT LL8.01

allow Ss time to read in silence, or play the recording so they can listen and read. Ask *Does the Time Traveller's mood change through the extract?* (yes). Divide Ss into pairs and ask them to think of a word to describe his mood for each paragraph. (e.g. paragraph 1: curious/ wondering; paragraph 2: afraid; paragraph 3: panicked; paragraph 4: relieved; paragraph 5: relaxed/confident/ curious).

Then ask them to identify the event or observation that is the main cause of each mood change. (paragraph 1: arriving in the rain; paragraph 2: realising he knows nothing about where he is; paragraph 3: the weather changes; paragraph 4: he has put the Time Machine the right way up again and knows it is ready to leave; paragraph 5: he sees people that don't look strong.)

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2 LL8.01 **Focus Ss on Question 1. Elicit whether the answer is true or false, or if the answer is not given in the text they have read. If they volunteer that the sentence is true or false, ask them to find the place in the text where it says so. They should not be able to find anything if the answer is not given in the text. Explain that they must decide if the rest of the questions are true, false or the information is not given.**

Allow time for them to work individually and then compare answers with a partner. Get feedback as a class, making sure they can justify their answers.

ANSWERS:
1 NG **2** F **3** F **4** T **5** T **6** T

LISTENING

3 LL8.02 **Focus Ss on the picture of the burning sun at the bottom of the page. Ask *What is happening here?* Do not confirm answers at this stage. Ask *How many years in the future is this?* Explain that this is what the Time Traveller's next journey looks like, 30 million years into the future.**

Focus on the glossary words in the box. Play the recording once or twice as Ss need, allowing them to make notes if they wish. After the first listen, see if they can tell you what is happening.

ANSWERS:
Earth is dying because the Sun is dying.

Write the following words on the board for Ss to make notes about as they listen: *the sun; the sky; the beach; the sea; animals; the stars; the weather; sounds*. Play the recording again for them to make notes. Then let them compare with a partner. Finally, allow them a third listen if necessary and/or for them to read the audio script in the back of the Students' Book for any missing details. Discuss as a class to build a picture of this dying world. Ask *Would you like to travel in time to the end of the world?*

LL8.02 AUDIOSCRIPT

'So I travelled, stopping now and again, every thousand years or more, wanting to know what happened to the Earth. I watched, with a strange interest, the sun grow larger and **duller** in the western sky, and the life of the old Earth die away. At last, more than thirty million years from now, the enormous red Sun covered almost a tenth of the **darkening** sky.

'Then I stopped again. The red beach, except for its green plants, seemed **lifeless**. A strong cold attacked me and snow fell from time to time. There was ice along the edge of the sea, with large pieces further out, but most of that salt ocean – all blood red under the sky – was not yet frozen.

'I looked around me to see if any animals were still alive, but I saw nothing moving, on the land, or in the sky, or sea. A low island of sand had appeared in the sea and the water had moved back from the beach. The stars in the sky were very bright.

'Suddenly, I noticed that the shape of the Sun in the west had changed and that something was moving into its circle. For a minute, perhaps, I didn't understand but then I realised that either the Moon or Mercury was passing across the Sun.

'It became darker and darker, a cold wind began to blow from the east and the snow fell more and more heavily. Except for these lifeless sounds the world was silent. Silent? All the everyday sounds of people, and of sheep, birds and insects – all that had ended. As it grew darker, the snow fell more heavily and it turned colder. The soft wind grew stronger. In another moment only the pale stars could be seen. Everything else was dark. The sky was completely black.

ACTIVE INVESTIGATION

4 **Tell Ss that although the idea of a Time Machine seems very well known to us, HG Wells was one of the first writers to use the idea. Ask *What other Time Machines can you think of from films, TV or books?* Elicit ideas onto the board. Then allow time, either in class or at home, for them to find other Time Machines and make a list. Check ideas as a class.**

ANSWERS:
Many possibilities but some are: Back to the Future (a Delorean car); *Dr Who* (the TARDIS); *Star Trek* (The USS Enterprise space ship); *Bill & Ted's Excellent Adventure* (a phone booth); *The Terminator* (time displacement equipment); *Timecop* (a rocket sled); *Harry Potter and the Prisoner of Azkaban* (a time turner); *Men in Black III* (time jump device).

Book: *How to Live Safely in a Science Fictional Universe*, Charles Yu, (general machine)

SPEAKING

5 **Focus Ss on the question and the words in the box. Divide them into pairs and give them time to discuss the ideas. Monitor and help with vocabulary as needed. There are no 'right' answers but you may want to lead them towards some of the ideas in the Answer Key to give them more to think about. Get feedback as a class and perhaps hold a vote to see which one the class sees as the biggest problem.**

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ANSWERS:

Ss' own ideas but suggestions are:

Money: You wouldn't have any of the currency used at the time. In the past, perhaps you could find some in the present, e.g. a shop that sells old things or, if travelling not too far back, you could make sure you only had coins and notes with older dates. In the future, you wouldn't know what the currency had become. So you couldn't buy anything and would have to steal.

Bacteria and illness: Anything you ate, drank or touched could make you ill as you might not have immunity to it. You'd be at least as ill as if you went to a foreign country and had food or water your body isn't used to. At worst, your body would shut down and you'd die. Clothes: You'd need to dress like locals or you'd be noticed very fast. And you'd only have what you could carry and no way to buy new ones.

Language: Language is always changing and you could sound very strange or not even be able to communicate, depending how far back or forwards you went. Sounding strange could get you into

a lot of trouble but it would make achieving anything difficult or impossible.

Getting older: Imagine you could live 85 years. If you could travel in time and spend five years in the past or future, you would return to the same moment you left, but you'd still be five years older. So then you would only have 80 years of your present life left because your body would still age. If you were away a long time, when you got back you'd look older.

Documents: You'd have no legal identification or proof of anything (unless you only go a few years into the future or past) so couldn't get a job or do anything official or legal. You'd need a very good explanation of why any legal records showed you were not the age you appear now, e.g. you have a valid passport but the date shows you would be a baby, or 150 years old. Getting fakes would need money – a lot of it – and friends who can break the law! You'd quickly be living a criminal life.

LL8.03 CLIL CONNECTION

Science

6 **Play the recording LL8.03 if necessary (you may not need to if you have already read it with the audio script as above). Tell Ss they are going to research to see how accurate HG Wells' description of the end of the Earth is, according to scientists' predictions. Focus on Questions 1–3 and allow time, either in class or at home, to research the answers. Ss could use the internet or reference books in the library. They should write their ideas down in full sentences to discuss and compare with a partner or in small groups.**

ANSWERS:

1 Ss may go into extreme detail with their research into this scenario (the 'red giant' phase of the Sun) but in general, Wells was correct that the Sun will get bigger and make everything hotter but he underestimated both. In the book the Sun seems to get to 1/10 of the sky. In reality, it will become so big it burns the Earth up and completely destroys it at extreme temperatures that will melt mountains into lava. After Earth is destroyed, the Sun will continue to grow. So although it will then be a cold and lifeless rock, you wouldn't be able to witness it from Earth as the Time Traveller did. The burned rock will be pushed out of the Sun's orbit. There wouldn't be any water or atmosphere left for there to be wind, clouds or snow, or any kind of weather at all. Mercury and Venus would be destroyed first by the expanding Sun because they're closer so the Time Traveller probably wouldn't see them passing the Sun.

2 About 5–7 billion years from now though it will probably be too hot to support life 1–1.5 billion years from now.

3 Ss' own ideas as the question could mean human civilisation or the planet itself. Theories include: human destruction of environmental resources; some kind of plague or disease with no cure; nuclear war; asteroid collision; Earth's core cools which would cause the loss of the atmosphere; biblical apocalypse; swallowed by a Black Hole; alien invasion; huge volcanic eruption.

Homework ideas

- Ss write an essay titled: *If I had a Time Machine, I would go to … .*
- Ss write the next part of the story from where the reading extract ends.
- Artistic Ss may like to paint or draw an interpretation of the end of the world as described in the Listening.
- Ss write a passage of descriptive writing, like the one in the Listening Lesson, describing the end of the Earth according to their research in CLIL Connection.

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